# Norah Zhou

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CX / Service Designer with a multidisciplinary background in UX design, business analysis, and information systems. Experienced in synthesizing user research, stakeholder needs, and data into service improvements and design decisions, with a strong understanding of how customer experiences connect to underlying processes and systems. Skilled in journey mapping, service blueprinting, prototyping, and cross-functional collaboration. Willing to relocate and available for short- and long-term business travel.

## EDUCATION

**University of Toronto** **Sep 2024 – Jun 2026**

**Master of Information, Information Systems Design & UX Design concentration** · *Toronto, ON*

*GPA: 3.9/4. Coursework included Service Design, User-Centred Information Systems Development, User Interface Design, and Accessibility and Inclusive Design*

**University of Alberta** *B.A. Philosophy, Minor in East Asian Studies · Edmonton, AB* **Jul 2017 – May 2021**

## SERVICE DESIGN & UX/UI PROJECTS (GRADUATE COURSEWORK, GROUP-BASED)

**Service Design for Elections Ontario's New Internship Program** **Jan – Apr 2026**

- Led service design, as part of a 5-person team, for a new one-year internship program at a provincial election administration agency, addressing gaps in onboarding, milestone tracking, and transition to early-career roles for graduate interns.
- Synthesized stakeholder and user interview data into a future-state journey map; co-designed and prototyped a badge system spanning front-stage (physical welcome kit, digital platform) and backstage (internal job portal) touchpoints.
- Ran 2 rounds of usability testing and iterated the prototype based on feedback; earned an A+ in a ranked course project.
- Defined KPIs and mapped stakeholder roles (HR, IT, Hiring Managers) across a phased implementation roadmap to support adoption and long-term talent retention.

**RadioVision: Healthcare Technology Marketing Website** **Jan – Apr 2026**

- Conducted UX research (stakeholder interviews, competitive audits, and a 200+ respondent survey analyzed in *Python*/*pandas*) for a healthcare technology company's website serving both B2B and B2C audiences, as part of a 5-person team.
- Designed a *Figma* design system and hi-fi UI prototype, mapping the user journey and iterating the design based on quantitative survey analysis to strengthen brand positioning.

**Flot: AI Workplace Sustainability Tool** **Mar 2026**

- Initiated the concept for Flot, a mindful AI workspace that tracks environmental impact and rewards sustainable AI usage; led UI design in *Figma* based on user interviews and desk research, as part of a 3-person team.
- Won 1st place at the 24-hour *UDesign Designathon 2026*.

**iSchool Wayfinding Redesign: Accessible & Inclusive Wayfinding System** **Sep – Dec 2025**

- Proposed an accessible wayfinding redesign for a university campus building, as part of a 6-person team, conducting on-site field observation to identify navigation pain points (inconsistent signage, unclear floor logic, no digital wayfinding tools).
- Designed a 3D building map in *Rhino* and prototyped consistent signage and orientation cues in *Figma*.

**Personal Portfolio Website** **Jun 2026**

- Designed and built a responsive portfolio website (*Next.js*, *Three.js*, *Tailwind CSS*), independently, to showcase design and development projects; deployed on *GitHub Pages*, iterating on functionality with AI-assisted coding tools.

## ENTERPRISE & BUSINESS SYSTEMS PROJECT

**Future-State Enterprise & Systems Architecture for a Financial Institution** **Feb – Apr 2026**

- Contributed to a future-state enterprise and systems architecture analysis, as part of a team, for a financial institution navigating post-merger data integration and a shift toward real-time, agent-driven decision-making.
- Applied the *Zachman Framework* and *ArchiMate* to model two future-state scenarios, standardizing 10 core entities into a canonical enterprise data model and designing new governance structures; this work translated complex banking data and system constraints directly into design decisions.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**University of Toronto, Faculty of Information · Career Services Team** **Sep 2024 – May 2026**

*Business Development & Data Analyst · Started as Co-op, converted to Full-time Contract* *Toronto, ON*

- Mapped the end-to-end service journey through which 2,000+ students discover and access Career Services support (newsletters, events, job postings, guides), applying service design thinking to identify communication gaps and introduce new engagement channels.
- Designed the content structure and layout for weekly newsletters and data visualization reports, translating career services data from *Symplicity*, a career services management platform, and employment and hiring trends into clear formats for internal stakeholders and student audiences.
- Consolidated employer hiring, event participation, and job-posting reports from *Symplicity* using Excel *XLOOKUP*; cleaned outdated records and prioritized employers in three tiers based on recruitment of Faculty of Information students, event participation, and opportunities provided over the previous three years to guide colleagues' outreach.
- Collaborated on the design and delivery of 5+ major career events per semester (job fairs, employer panels, peer-to-peer connectors), each drawing 180+ student attendees.

**Fortune Canada Business Consulting Inc.** **Mar 2022 – Sep 2023**

*Project Manager (immigration & visa advisory services)* *Richmond, BC*

- Mapped the end-to-end client case workflow and adapted *Zoho CRM* to support a 20-person team, configuring case pipelines, role-based access, and information ownership.
- Independently designed, configured, and tested an automated workflow that generated an invoice template and notified Finance for revision and approval when a consultant recorded receipt of an immigration approval letter.
- Led the migration of 150+ client records from fragmented Excel, internal tracking, and Word sources into *Zoho CRM*; validated an initial batch, trained colleagues, and checked migrated records for consistency and outdated or missing information.
- Clarified cross-department responsibilities and refined role-based access in response to rollout feedback, reducing unnecessary back-and-forth and improving visibility into case timelines, ownership, and progress.
- Analyzed market and search trends to guide a website rebuild with the IT team, reaching 2,000 daily visitors and a #1 Google (Chinese-language) ranking for "Immigration to Canada."
- Represented the company at the Chengdu Immigration Industry Summit, building relationships with 20+ business partners.

**Fortune Canada Business Consulting Inc.** **May 2021 – Feb 2022**

*Marketing Specialist* *Richmond, BC*

- Designed the company's brand identity and a full suite of promotional materials.
- Researched shifts in Canadian immigration policy to align marketing strategy with client demand.
- Ran digital marketing campaigns across key platforms, growing engagement and online community size.

## SKILLS

**Service Design & UX Research:** Service Blueprinting, Journey Mapping, Stakeholder & User Interviews, Usability Testing, Co-Design Workshops, Competitive Analysis, Rapid Prototyping (Lo-Fi to Hi-Fi), *Figma*

**CX Strategy & Business Analysis:** CX Strategy, Process Mapping (*BPMN*, *ERD*, *DFD*), Enterprise Architecture (*Zachman*, *ArchiMate*), *Zoho CRM* Configuration, Workflow Automation, Requirements Documentation (*SRS*), Stakeholder Communication & Reporting, SOP Development, *Agile/Scrum*, Project Management

**Technical:** HTML, *Tailwind CSS*, JavaScript, *React.js*, *Python*, *pandas*, *SQL/MySQL* (*JOIN*, *GROUP BY*, filtering and aggregation), Excel (*XLOOKUP*, data cleaning and consolidation), Adobe Photoshop, *Jira*, AI-assisted prototyping

**Professional Development:** Microsoft Power Platform, *Power Automate*, *Visio*, and *Power BI* (currently studying).

**Languages:** English, Mandarin Chinese (bilingual)

## CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

**Microsoft Business Analyst Professional Certificate (In Progress)** · *Microsoft via Coursera* **Oct 2026 – Present**

**Software Engineering Diploma** · *BrainStation Bootcamp · Vancouver, BC* **Jan 2024 – May 2024**

**Certificate in International Learning** · *University of Alberta · Edmonton, AB* **2019 – 2021**

*Focus: intercultural competence and global perspectives.*